

S. JAIPAL REDDY

Minister of Urban Development

Civic Monitor

Reddy has his task cut out: to effectively coordinate with some 54 agencies to make the Commonwealth Games, to be held in October, a success. The estimated expenditure would reach Rs 30,000 crore. And it's not an easy task given that Delhi is under tremendous pressure with a rising population, traffic problems, drainage mess and an impending security nightmare. Infrastructure upgradation and a beautification drive have reduced the city to a dug-up trench, and nearly half of the projects are running too late to be completed in time for the Games.

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Achievements

I He has initiated work on most of his promises. For instance, Metro projects have been launched in as many as 10 cities.

I The Rs 1,00,000-crore Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Renewable Mission covering 63 major cities has shown signs of progress while schemes for infrastructure development in 13 satellite towns were fast-tracked.

Failures

I Lack of movement on the long expected vision statement to decongest existing metros. The big idea of creating new cities across India is yet to take off.

I Sanitation investments continue to be planned in a piecemeal manner and do not take into account the full cycle of safe confinement, treatment and safe disposal.

Buzz Around Him

His great working rapport with Delhi Chief Minister Sheila Dikshit is being talked about. Also, those close to him say that he harbours a secret ambition to be the first chief minister of Telangana.

▼ 36%

DINSHA J. PATEL

Minister of State for Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

Micro Vision

Although he **did not** lead the industry well during the economic crisis, Patel is now trying to **make up** for it. He has launched a **number of** schemes and was able to achieve a **34 per cent** increased plan **allocation** for his ministry. He persuaded the PMO to set up a task force for the MSME sector.

Missing in Action

Communication with the small-scale industry associations.



M.K. ALAGIRI

Minister of Chemicals and Fertilisers

Lost in Translation

His continued absence from Parliament angered the Opposition and embarrassed the Government. He crossed paths with Finance Minister Pranab Mukherjee over changes in the fertiliser policy, but lost the battle.



Two is Company

He counts Kamal Nath among his few friends in Delhi.

▼ 28%